CITY OF OCEANSIDE
MEASURE S

(This measure will appear on the ballot in the following form.)

MEASURE S

To provide locally-controlled funding for Oceanside services and infrastructure, such as keeping streets, sidewalks, parks, and public facilities safe, clean, and well-maintained; fixing potholes; improving traffic; restoring/protecting local beaches; modernizing public safety/emergency facilities to improve 911 emergency response/community safety; and repairing aging infrastructure, shall City of Oceanside's ordinance establishing a 1/2 cent sales tax be adopted, providing $20,000,000 annually for general government use for 10 years, with independent audits and citizen oversight?

This measure requires Simple Majority (50%+1) of those voting on the measure.

CITY ATTORNEY IMPARTIAL ANALYSIS

Measure "S" was placed on the ballot by the Oceanside City Council and proposes to increase the transactions and use tax (commonly referred to as the "sales tax") by one-half of one percent (0.5%) on retail sales within the City of Oceanside ("City"). If approved, the tax would commence on or after April 1, 2027 and would remain in place for ten years.

Measure S's sales tax would be levied under state law (Revenue and Taxation Code Section 7285.9). As such, it would be collected as a percentage of gross receipts from retail sales and other taxable uses occurring within the City. The current sales tax rate in Oceanside is 8.25%. If Measure S is approved, the sales tax rate would increase to 8.75%. The tax revenues generated from the additional 0.5% would go to the City less a state administrative fee.

The City estimates that Measure S, if adopted, will generate approximately $20 million annually. These revenues are authorized to be used for any lawful municipal purpose. This includes expenditures for services and infrastructure, such as keeping streets, sidewalks, parks, and public facilities safe, clean, and well-maintained, fixing potholes, restoring/protecting local beaches, modernizing public safety and emergency facilities to improve 911 emergency response and community safety, and repairing aging infrastructure. Because the revenues raised by Measure S can be used for any general governmental purpose, a majority of voters must approve Measure S for the tax to go into effect.

If adopted, Measure S adds Sections 34.7.1 – 34.7.17 to the Oceanside City Code setting forth the nature and amount of the proposed increase as well as how it is required to be administered. Measure S requires a Citizens' Oversight Committee ("COC") to be responsible for annually making recommendations to the City Council on a spending plan for the revenues generated by Measure S. The COC will also be responsible for reviewing the annual independent audit of the revenues and expenditures of funds generated by Measure S. All expenditures of Measure S fund monies will be tracked and accounted for by City's Financial Services Department as a separate line item in the General Fund and in accordance with Generally Accepted Accounting Principles (GAAP).

A "yes" vote on Measure S favors increasing the sales tax by one-half of one percent for ten years.

A "no" vote on Measure S opposes an increase in the sales tax by one-half of one percent for ten years.

The above statement is an impartial analysis of Measure S. If you desire a copy of the proposed City Code amendment, please call the City Clerk's Office at (760) 435-3001 and a copy will be mailed to you at no cost. The text of Measure S can also be accessed at the following website: https://www.ci.oceanside.ca.us/government/city-clerk/elections-fair-political-practices-commission-reporting-program/current-elections.

Dated: August 14, 2026

T. Steven Burke, Jr., City Attorney

ARGUMENT AGAINST MEASURE S

The CITY wants MORE TAXES! Vote NO on Measure S

We just approved a sales tax two years ago. It will raise $ 200m over the next 10 years. None of that money has been spent! Now they want another $ 200m! This double dipping is unfair! Oceanside residents, especially our families and seniors, will be hit hard at the cash register. **Unfair, unfair, unfair**!

The City says the things they want to do are essential. If that's true, then why have they waited so long to make them happen? Where is the exact plan? How much will these things really cost? What other funding sources have they explored? Will they just keep coming back and asking us for MORE taxes?

The sales tax measure will absolutely NOT cover the costs of a new police headquarters, a new fire station and rehab of the pier. So how do you imagine this sales tax will also fix our potholes, put sand on the beach and address other priority issues like homelessness? Promising so many projects is a ploy to get those funds in the hands of council. This is a general tax and IS NOT for specific projects. They can spend the money on anything they want, not what you think was promised.

The politicians get a slush fund and we get the bill!

Approving this tax will make Oceanside's taxes higher than adjoining cities. This will hurt local business who are already struggling in today's economy.

Vote NO on Measure S and put Oceanside residents and businesses first.

Steven Burrell
Senior Advocate

Rocky Chavez
Former State Assembly Member

Jeordie Fellner
Retired Oceanside School Teacher
Community Advocate

Michele L. Cyr
Licensed Clinical Social Worker

Karie Lasko
Former Small Business Owner
Alternate Manufactured Home Fair Practices Commissioner